

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

Study Order — 1) Shen 2) Su Wen 32 face map 3) Five Colors 4) Five Wheels & eye findings 5) other sense organs/tissues 6) secretions + infant vein 7) Constitution (flagged, lowest priority).

1 · Framework	
Method	Uses
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)
Auscultation/Olfaction	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)
Inquiry	Verbal questioning
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse

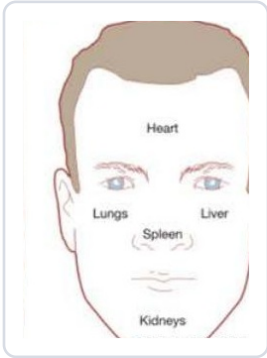
Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

2 · Shen (Vitality)			
Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, conscious, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish and slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady
Heads Up — False Shen = sudden brightening in a critical patient. Warning sign, NOT recovery.			

Deranged Shen (shén luàn)

Deranged Shen	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation
Zàng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no LOC
Bái hé bīng	Chronic depression, mumbling, insomnia, sleepwalking
Diān (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities

Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map



Drawn as if facing the patient — their left cheek is on YOUR right.

Su Wen 32 face map (Maciocia Fig. 23.1), via Prof. Lao's Week 6 slides. Used for internal class study only.

Region (patient's own left/right)	Organ
L cheek (patient's)	Liver
Forehead	Heart
Nose	Spleen
R cheek (patient's)	Lung
Chin	Kidney

Quick Recall: Face-forward pictures mirror this — patient's left is on YOUR right.

3 · Five Colors of Face	
Color	Indication
Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)
Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency (puffy=yang qi def; withered=blood def)
Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)
Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion
Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.

Secretions: Color Rule

Finding	Meaning
Clear/white	Deficiency/cold
Turbid/yellow	Excess/heat

4 • Appearance, Body Shape & Movement

Body Shape

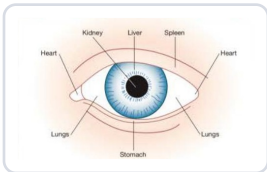
Finding	Pattern
Overweight + depression	Qi deficiency + excess phlegm-damp
Thin person, dry skin	Blood insufficiency
Great weight loss, long illness	Exhaustion of essential Qi
Large barrel chest/epigastrium	Full (excess) lung/stomach condition
Large, overweight thighs	Spleen not transforming/transporting
Thin body overall	Yin deficiency
Overweight body overall	Yang deficiency with phlegm

Movement & Posture

Finding	Pattern
Active movement	Yang syndrome
Passive manner	Yin syndrome
Violent limb movement	Wind disease (tetanus, infantile convulsion)
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome (painful obstruction)
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia / wind-stroke
Quick movement + heat	Excess Yang
Slow movement + cold	Yang deficiency
Small, restless fidgeting	Empty (deficiency) heat
Tremors, convulsions	Wind (involuntary movement)
Paralysis	Internal wind
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stagnation, blood stasis, and/or wind

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yang deficiency (NOT Yin deficiency – Yin deficiency causes heat, not cold).

5 • Eyes: Five Wheels



Five Wheels of the Eye — source: Maciocia, The Foundations of Chinese Medicine (3rd ed.), via Prof. Schrier's Week 6 slides. Used for internal class study only.

Wheel	Structure	Organ
Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Qi	Sclera	Lung
Wind	Iris	Liver
Water	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh	Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Spleen/Stomach

Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.

Eye Color

Color	Pattern
Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)	Damp-heat, heat predominant
Dull, dusky yellow	Damp-heat, damp predominant
Dull, dark yellow	Cold-damp
Deep yellow + bloodshot	Toxic heat in the blood level
Dull, dark yellow-brown	Blood stasis (dark rings, purple tongue)
Red (inner/outer canthus)	Heart fire (or SI, if outer canthus)
Red, entire eye + headache	Rising Liver fire
Red sclera, sore throat, cough	Exterior wind-heat affecting Lung
Sudden red + itching + aversion to cold	Exterior invasion of wind-heat
Blue-green	Liver wind (tremor, dizziness, numbness, paralysis)
Bluish	Internal cold, or Kidney Yin deficiency

Color	Pattern
Dark sclera (crab-eye black)	Accumulated heat
Dark eye sockets, sunken	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency
White rings around iris	Turbid phlegm
Cloudy white iris	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency
Pale white vessels in canthus	Blood or Yang deficiency

Quick Recall: Yellow=damp, Red=heat/fire, Blue-green=wind/cold, Black/dark=extreme heat OR extreme cold, White=deficiency/phlegm.

Eye Shape & Movement

Presentation	Pattern
Bulging/protruding + anger, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang rising w/ heat+damp
Protruding + neck swelling, tinnitus, 5-center heat	Liver Yin def. w/ relative Yang excess
Sunken + slight cough, weak voice	Lung deficiency
Sunken + poor appetite, distention, limb weakness	Spleen deficiency
Sunken, sudden onset, deep/scattered pulse	Yin/Yang collapse (severe)
Swollen, sudden onset, no color change	Fluid malfunction (Spleen def. w/ damp)
Bags under the eyes	Spleen & Kidney deficiency
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling	Wind attacking channels
Deviation + nausea, vomiting, greasy coat	Wind-damp-phlegm obstruction
Both eyes deviate up/high fever/coma	Extreme heat generating wind
Deviation after trauma	Blood stasis
Presentation	Pattern
Congenital deviation	Essence deficiency (Kidney)
Frequent spasms, dry itchy eyes, pale, thready pulse	Blood deficiency
Eyelids heavy/tired feeling	Spleen Qi deficiency
Occasional spasm + red/itchy + fever/chills	Exterior invasion (wind-heat)
Droopy eyelids (ptosis)	Qi sinking, or wind attacking channels

6-9 • Nose, Ears, Mouth Group, Hair/Nails/Skin — Top-Yield Only

Heads Up — Compressed for speed. Full tables for every finding below are in the Study Guide, Sections 6-9.

6 • Nose (Lung + Spleen)

Finding	Pattern
Green/blue tip	Cold
Red tip	Heat
Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out

Edema Starts In	Organ
Upper body/head	Lung
Lower body/feet	Kidney
4 limbs/torso	Spleen

7 • Ears (Kidney)

Finding	Pattern
Long, full earlobes	Strong constitution
Small earlobes	Poor constitution
Purulent discharge ("Tin Er")	Damp-heat Liver/GB
Dry, withered, black auricle	Kidney essence exhausted

Tinnitus	Organ
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney

8 • Teeth (Kidney) / Gums (Spleen-Stomach)

Finding	Pattern
White, moist, bright teeth	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry, no sheen teeth	Kidney Yin decline
Gray/black teeth	Exhaustion of Yin and Yang
Deep red + swelling gums	Excess heat / Stomach fire
Blue line, teeth/gums	Mercury poisoning

Lips & Mouth (Spleen) / Throat & Tonsils

Finding	Pattern
Pale lips	Blood deficiency
Purple lips	Blood stasis (stabbing pain) — NOT only cold, see Recognition Traps
Crimson lips	Yin-deficiency heat
Deviated mouth	Wind
Mouth open + fever/thirst	Excess heat
Deep red throat	Heat
Chronic dry throat, NOT swollen	Lung/Kidney Yin deficiency, empty heat
Acute red + swollen throat	Wind invasion (exterior)

9 • Hair (Blood/Kidney) / Nails (Liver) / Skin

Finding	Pattern
Premature graying	Depletion of Kidney essence
Dull, brittle hair	Liver Blood deficiency
Falling out in patches	Blood deficiency within channels
Nail blanch returns immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood
Nail blanch returns slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Ridged nails	Kidney Yin def., Liver Yang rising
Spoon-shaped nails	Malnutrition, Spleen deficiency
Yellow, orangish skin	Damp-heat, more heat than damp
Dry skin	Blood/fluid deficiency
Itching	Wind
Pitting edema	Yang edema, Spleen/Kidney Yang def.
Skin Lesion	Cause
Papule / Macule	Raised+fades w/ pressure / flat+doesn't fade
Yong (Yang) / Ju (Yin) carbuncle	Fire toxins / Qi-Blood-Yin-cold stagnation

10 • Secretions/Excretions Logic

Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess
Color	White	Yellow
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty
Odor	None/faint	Strong

Quick Recall: White/thin/profuse/no-odor = cold-deficiency. Yellow/thick/scanty/strong-odor = heat-excess.

11 • Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis

Age <3. Left index finger=boys, right index finger=girls.

Gate Reached	Severity
Wind Gate only	Mild illness / exterior pathogen
Qi Gate	Interior condition, stronger illness
Life Gate	Severe illness
Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening

Vein Color	Indication
Light red, not very visible	Normal
Bright red	Heat
Purple	Stronger heat, creating stasis
Green or dark blue	Wind

Recognition Traps — Common Miscalls

Trap	Correct Discriminator
Red throat = always excess	Chronic, dry, NOT swollen red throat can be Yin-deficiency empty heat instead
Open mouth = always excess	Open + fever/thirst = excess heat. Open + SOB/frothy sputum = Lung deficiency with phlegm
Purple lips = only cold	Purple can also mean Blood stasis (stabbing pain)
"Slow movement + cold" = Yin deficiency	It's Yang deficiency. Yin deficiency causes HEAT signs, not cold
Any yellow finding = heat	Yellow = damp/deficiency in general; only bright/orange leans heat
Nail bed blanch: any return = normal	SLOW return = exhaustion of Qi/Blood — the speed is the diagnostic
Eye wheel Kidney = Right Chi pulse Kidney	Separate systems. Right Chi PULSE = Pericardium/San Jiao
Left/right cheek = your left/right	Su Wen 32 uses the PATIENT'S own left/right. Face-forward pictures are mirrored

Heads Up — Quiz Move — For every local sign: color/shape → thermal nature → excess/deficiency → organ/channel → one confirming symptom.

12 • Constitutional Types (Flagged)

Heads Up — Scope conflict: Prof. Lao's recorded lecture says "Nothing on the body constitutions" will be tested. Prof. Schrier's own deck devotes ~9/41 slides to it. Confirm with him which governs the quiz. Full Five-Element and Weak/Strong Constitution tables are in the Study Guide, Section 14 — skip memorizing them here unless he confirms it's tested.